REES W. PAYNE

GAMEPLAY ENGINEER | UNREAL ENGINE 5 | C++ | GAMEPLAY SYSTEMS

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Open to Relocation

SUMMARY

Gameplay programmer and software engineer with hands-on experience developing, implementing, and debugging gameplay systems in Unreal Engine 5 using Blueprints and Gameplay Ability System (GAS). Experienced in iterative gameplay development, collaborative prototyping, playtesting, and delivering weekly playable builds. Additional software engineering experience in C++, Git workflows, code reviews, and performance optimization. Duke University M.Eng. in Game Design, Development & Innovation and B.S. in Computer Science.

EDUCATION

Duke University, Pratt School of Engineering | M.Eng., Game Design, Development & Innovation | May 2026

Duke University, Trinity College of Arts & Sciences | B.S., Computer Science | May 2024

GAME DEVELOPMENT EXPERIENCE

TenByTen Games | Game Programmer / Game Developer | Durham, NC | Oct 2024–Present

- Develop and debug Unreal Engine 5 gameplay systems for Manga Hero, a playable 3D action game, implementing interactive gameplay functionality using Blueprints and Gameplay Ability System (GAS) while collaborating with a seven-person team to deliver weekly playable builds.
- Prototype, implement, and refine interactive gameplay features using Unreal Engine 5 and Level Sequencer, integrating functionality and validating gameplay through iterative playtesting.
- Diagnose, troubleshoot, and resolve gameplay defects in Unreal Engine 5; collaborate with developers to implement fixes and validate gameplay functionality through testing.
- Develop and iterate on 12 playable environments through grayboxing and level design, integrating interactive gameplay elements and audio using Wwise.
- Coordinate gameplay development tasks using Agile practices, collaborating with teammates on implementation, testing, and iterative improvements.

Duke Health | Game Developer | Durham, NC | Sep 2025–Dec 2025

- Developed and debugged gameplay functionality and scalable Godot UI systems for Pick 5, an educational game supporting multiplayer sessions and user-uploaded cases.
- Collaborated with stakeholders and used playtesting and player telemetry to identify defects and guide gameplay improvements.

SOFTWARE ENGINEERING EXPERIENCE

Murano Corporation | Junior Software Engineer | Durham, NC | Jan 2026–Present

- Reduced device boot and application startup time by 50% through performance optimization of a proprietary Linux-based mobile operating system.
- Develop application functionality and UI for wireless messaging, filesystem visualization, and music-player applications.
- Manage GitHub branch workflows, review and approve merges, and write technical documentation and testing guides.

iD Tech Camps | Lead Instructor | Durham, NC | Jun 2025–Jul 2025

- Taught Python programming and Unreal Engine 5 game development; led groups of 30+ students through development projects.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: C++, C, Python, Lua, JavaScript, QML, HTML/CSS

Game Development: Unreal Engine 5, Blueprints, Gameplay Ability System (GAS), Level Sequencer, gameplay systems, Godot, Wwise

Engineering & Tools: Linux, Git, GitHub, debugging, performance optimization, playtesting, telemetry analysis, Agile development